6 The Challenges of Peace-making 1991–2008: Israelis and Palestinians

POINTS TO CONSIDER

This chapter will focus on the challenges of peace-making between the Israelis and the Palestinians. It will examine the successes of the 1990s as well as the obstacles that have hindered the subsequent development of the peace process.

These are considered under the following headings:

- The Israeli–Palestinian peace agreement 1993
- The problems of peace-making 1993–9
- The second *Intifada* and after 2000–8

Key dates

1974	Arafat's speech to the UN
1990	Iraqi invasion of Kuwait
1993 and 1995	Oslo Accords
1994	Israel–Jordan peace treaty
1995	Assassination of Rabin
2000	Camp David peace negotiations Beginning of the second *Intifada*
2002	Operation Defensive Shield
2003	'Road map' to peace
2004	Death of Yasser Arafat Mahmoud Abbas elected President of the Palestinian Authority
2006	Hamas victory in Palestinian elections Israeli invasion of Lebanon

1 | The Israeli–Palestinian Peace Agreement 1993

This chapter will concentrate on peace-making between Israelis and Palestinians in the 1990s and early twenty-first century. First, however, we must look at an earlier example of peace-making. In 1974, at the height of hijacking and hostage-taking by PLO extremists, Yasser Arafat and other moderate PLO leaders hinted that they were ready to consider a 'mini-state' for the Palestinians – consisting of the West Bank and Gaza where the majority of the inhabitants were Palestinian. In other words, they were no longer determined to destroy the state of Israel.